

I experienced the Optoma UHR90DV projector

This is certainly not meant for your living room

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The Optoma UHR90DV is, without question, the most ambitious projector the company has ever built. I was invited to an exclusive showcase hosted by Optoma and Listening Lab at MCBEE Studios in New Delhi where the company officially launched this 15.9-lakh rupees behemoth of a projection system that's as flagship as cinema projectors go. For starters, the UHR90DV is the only triple-laser RGB projector in India to receive both Dolby Vision and IMAX Enhanced seal of approvals. This means you can take its name in the same breath as a professional cinema equipment.

The flagship has arrived

Before I even took a step into the demo room, Vijay Sharma, Managing Director of Optoma India briefed the gathering talking about what this projector meant to Optoma. He started by saying, "When we talk about Optoma projectors, we talk about colour accuracy, we talk about contrast and we talk about the cinematic experience. The new lineup we are launching is more in line with the cinema industry, basically bringing the professional cinema to the fore."

Sharma showed us a slide during his presentation with charts mapping the apparent decline in lamp-based home cinema projectors. The chart shows

sales dropping from roughly 17.9 thousand units in 2022 to a projected 10.3 thousand by 2025. At the same time, solid-state projection systems, particularly laser models, witnessed a rising trend. It climbed from about 0.4 thousand units in 2021 to an estimated 8.8 thousand units by 2025.

"With lamp projectors, the consumable is the lamp. Every one or two years people had to change it. With solid-state you don't have to worry about the light source for five or ten years," he added.

The UHR90DV runs three laser light sources, red, green and blue, to achieve 96% coverage of the BT.2020 colour space, a standard typically associated with mastering suites and professional grading monitors and not living rooms. It pumps out 5,000 ISO lumens, claims a contrast ratio of 4,500,000:1 and backs all of it with Filmmaker Mode, HDR10+, motorised lens control with memory and a 30,000-hour light source rated to last decades of regular use.

Nishant Padhiar of Listening Labs and one of the premier voices in the Indian Hi-Fi space also shared his experience of the UHR90DV, saying that, "the one thing that I like about this projector is, apart from all the great things like the color fidelity, the

contrast, is the brightness, the 5000 lumens. Optoma is not kidding around with that. It genuinely is 5000 lumens and that really gives you that headroom for HDR that makes it look wow. The moment you switch on even

an Apple TV home screen, the way it just captures you know your imagination, your eyeballs. It's truly incredible."

How is the experience?

On a screen stretched wide enough to swallow your peripheral vision, the UHR90DV was given content worthy of its capabilities including curated sequences from IMAX Enhanced material,

presented on the 120" screen in the correct IMAX aspect ratio, alongside scenes from films such as 1917, The Batman, Ready Player One, chosen to stress-test contrast, colour, and motion.

The first thing that stands out on the UHR90DV is how vibrant the image looks without feeling exaggerated. Laser projectors sometimes push colours into territory that feels overly saturated, particularly with reds and greens. In this case, the reds and greens had clear intensity, but they stayed within a believable range. Skin tones held up well too, even when scenes shifted between bright daylight and darker interiors.

Colour balance was consistent across sequences. In several scenes the blacks appeared deeper than the grey cinema bars on the screen. There was perceivable depth to scenes, as dark scenes retained dimension and texture rather than collapsing into flat planes of near-black. **d**



Vijay Sharma
Managing Director,
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